

Daily Current Affairs — Morning Session

Class Notes | Date: 12 September 2026 | Target Exams: SSC CGL / CHSL / CPO / Steno / Railway

1. Operation BRICS Kavach & 18th BRICS Summit

The 18th edition of the **BRICS Summit** is being held in **New Delhi** (Bharat Mandapam — same venue as the 2023 G20 Summit) from now until **13 September 2026**. With major global leaders present, security was a top priority for India.

- Total member countries: **11**; newest/latest member: **Indonesia**.
- President Putin (Russia) arrived with his own aircraft, the **IL-76**.
- For all other visiting leaders, security has been provided by **NSG Commandos** (National Security Guard), also known as **Black Cat Commandos** — famous for their role in **Operation Blue Star (1984)**.
- Their newly launched security operation for this summit is named **Operation BRICS Kavach** — aimed at protecting the global leaders attending.
- After the summit concludes, a '**Delhi Declaration**' will be issued.
- This is the **4th time India has hosted** a BRICS Summit (2 in-person + 1 virtual previously).
- Last BRICS Summit was hosted by **Brazil**.
- India's BRICS **Sherpa: Sudhakar Dalela** — first time BRICS has appointed a dedicated Sherpa.
- PM Modi gifted President Putin a Tamil literature book titled '**Thirukkural**' (also called Kural/Kurunai), translated into Russian. It has **133 chapters**, each with 10 couplets, divided into 3 parts covering Ethics, Religion/Philosophy, Politics/Governance, Justice, Love, Friendship, Wealth and Humanity. Putin also reportedly read the Bhagavad Gita during his journey.
- 2026 Key Summits: BRICS – India; SCO – Kyrgyzstan; ASEAN – Philippines; G7 – France; APEC – China; NATO – Turkey; COP – Turkey.
- Chinese leader attending: **Xi Jinping**. Russian leader attending: **Vladimir Putin**.

2. UPI 'Tap & Pay' and 'My UPI' Platform Launched

New UPI facilities were launched by **NPCI** (National Payments Corporation of India, functions under RBI; HQ Mumbai; formed 2007, functional since 2008) at the **Global Fintech Summit, Mumbai (2026)**, inaugurated by **Sanjay Malhotra, 26th RBI Governor**.

- **UPI Tap & Pay**: Just tap your phone on the payment machine — no need to open the UPI app, enter PIN, or even have internet/network. Payments up to **Rs. 5,000** can be made without PIN.
- **My UPI Pay**: Lets users file a complaint/block UPI access if their phone is lost or SIM is blocked, preventing misuse of their number for payments.
- NPCI earlier launched UPI and the BHIM App in **2016**.

3. Today's Exam (Steno) — Repeated GK/GS Questions Discussed

- Kumbh Mela is held at: Nasik, Ujjain, Haridwar, Prayagraj.
- 'Reti' is an opening strategy in the game of **Chess**. (Norway Chess Championship winner: **Praggnanandhaa**.)
- Articles: Rajya Sabha – **Art. 80**; Lok Sabha – **Art. 81**; Parliament – **Art. 79**; President – **Art. 52**.
- **First woman Army Officer from Kargil: Stanzin Sangyan** (age 24). She trained via NCC, did her training in Chennai, and became Kargil's first woman to join the Indian Army as an officer.
- Ladakh has two main districts — **Leh** and **Kargil** (plus 5 more added later). A new Article **371** is expected for Ladakh; possible inclusion under the **6th Schedule** being discussed (Sonam Wangchuk protest planned for 19th).
- Ladakh Geography (Trans-Himalayan ranges): **Karakoram** (highest peak: **K2 / Godwin Austen**) → **Ladakh Range** (highest peak: **Rakaposhi / Saltoro Kangri**) → **Zaskar Range** (highest peak: **Kamet**). Together, these three form the **Trans-Himalayas**. Great Himalayan Range's highest peak: **Mount Everest**.
- The **e-Governance Development Index** is released — NOT by NITI Aayog (a new/unusual question).
- **First Deputy Chairperson of the Planning Commission: Gulzarilal Nanda**.
- '**Jobless Growth**' concept is associated with the **1991 Economic Reforms (LPG – Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation)**.
- **Mohiniyattam** dance (from Kerala, also performed in Tamil Nadu): the white saree with golden border is called a '**Kasavu**' saree — it symbolises **peace and sacrifice**.

4. Exercise Samudra Laxman 2026 (India–Malaysia)

Exercise Samudra Laxman is a naval exercise between **India and Malaysia** — the **4th edition** of this maritime exercise, hosted by **Malaysia**, starting **9 September 2026**.

- Malaysia: located in South-East Asia on the **Malay Peninsula**; Capital: **Kuala Lumpur**; Currency: **Ringgit**.
- India–Malaysia has 3 exercises: Army – **Harimau Shakti**; Navy – **Samudra Laxman**; Air Force – **Udara Shakti**.
- India is represented by **INS Mysore** (Project 15, Delhi-class destroyer, built at **Mazagon Dock, Mumbai**).
- (Recall) **Exercise Yudh Abhyas** — India & **USA**, conducted in two phases: Rajasthan and Uttarakhand.

5. Quick Geography & Science Facts

- Layer below the Mantle is liquid (molten) because of increasing density and temperature as we go from Crust → Mantle → Core.
- Rivers **NOT** originating from the Deccan Plateau (from the given options): Major Deccan rivers are **Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri**.
- **Night blindness (Night Vision Deficiency)** is caused by deficiency of **Vitamin A (Retinol)**.
- **National Games 2022** mascot was named '**Sawaj**' (a lion); hosted in **Gujarat**.

6. Princess Elizabeth Island — Belgium

Belgium is developing the world's **first artificial energy island**, named **Princess Elizabeth Island**, in the **North Sea**, for producing offshore (wind) energy, which will then be transmitted to Belgium via **underwater cables**. Project completion target: **2028**.

- Belgium: located in Europe; Capital: **Brussels** (HQ of NATO and the European Union); borders the **North Sea**.
- North Sea bordering countries (mnemonic '**NOBEDS**): **N**orway, **B**elgium, **G**ermany, **F**rance, **E**ngland, **N**etherlands, **D**enmark, **S**cotland.
- **Strait of Dover** lies between England and France, connecting to the English Channel.

7. Wildlife, Geography & Polity Points

- **Gir Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat)** is famous for **Asiatic Lions**; also known for **Banni grassland**.
- Harvest festival involving cattle worship: e.g. **Sonpur Mela (Bihar)**; also note **Sarhul festival** (harvest festival).
- **Aravalli Range** is in **Rajasthan**; highest point **Guru Shikhar** on **Mount Abu** (new name: '**Abu Raj**').
- Indus Valley Civilisation had trade relations with **Egypt and Mesopotamia**.

- The concept of '**Residuary Powers**' (and the Concurrent List) in the Indian Constitution was borrowed from **Australia**.

8. PM-SETU Yojana (ITI Development) — Rs. 735.70 crore

PM-SETU Yojana (Scaling Employability & Training through Upgradation) is a **Central Government skill-development scheme**, launched in **2025**, running till **2030**, aimed at improving vocational training/ITI infrastructure to build **Viksit Bharat 2047**.

- Focus areas: **Pragati, Samridhi, Samavesh**.
- Plans to develop **200 ITIs (Industrial Training Institutes)** and open **5 National Skill Training Institutes**.
- Latest allocation: **Rs. 735.70 crore** for **3 new ITIs** in **Telangana, Rajasthan, and Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)**.

9. New State Schemes

- **Uttarakhand** — '**Yuva Bhavishya Nirman Yojana**': Launched by CM **Pushkar Singh Dhami** on **5 September 2026** (Teachers' Day, also International Charity Day dedicated to Mother Teresa). Provides **free online coaching** for SSC, Railway, UPSC etc. First phase covers **11,000 students**, called '**CM Yuva**'.
- **Karnataka** — '**Gram Anubhav**' Yojana: For students of Classes 8–12; a **2-day village exposure tour** (funded at **Rs. 25,000**) to expose students to rural life, agriculture, biogas/cow-dung usage etc.

10. World's Highest-Paid Prime Ministers

As per a recent report on annual PM salaries: **1) Singapore** — **Lawrence Wong** (~Rs. 27 crore/year); **2) Hong Kong** (~Rs. 5 crore/year); **3) Switzerland**; ...**India** — **PM Narendra Modi** (~Rs. 24 lakh/year).

- Singapore also ranks **No. 1** on the **Henley Passport Index**; its **Changi Airport** is regarded as the world's most beautiful airport.
- Singapore: Capital — **Singapore City**; located on the **Malay Peninsula, north of the Equator**; near the **Johor Strait** and **Malacca**.

11. Bihar Floods — Current Situation

- Around **46 lakh people** affected; about **11 lakh people** displaced from their homes; roughly **15 districts** affected (incl. Patna, Bhagalpur).
- Cause: heavy rainfall + water flow from **Nepal** through rivers: **Gandak, Kosi, Punpun**.
- **Gandak River**: originates in the Himalayas (India–Nepal–Tibet); called '**Narayani**' in Nepal; a tributary of the **Ganga**. **Valmiki National Park** lies near the Gandak.
- **Kosi River**: also Himalayan-origin, a Ganga tributary; known as the '**Sorrow of Bihar**'.
- **NDRF** (National Disaster Response Force) and the State Disaster Response Force are conducting relief operations.

12. Sports News

- **Sree Charani** (left-arm spinner) became the **fastest Indian (men & women combined)** to take **50 wickets in T20 cricket** — achieved in **29 matches**, during India vs Bangladesh (semifinal) of the ongoing **Women's Asia Cup 2026**, hosted in **Dubai** (dismissed Bangladesh's Fardews for the milestone).
- For comparison, **Kuldeep Yadav** had achieved the same feat in **30 matches**.
- **Vaibhav Suryavanshi** — youngest player to score the fastest fifty (recent record).
- **Dileep Trophy** recently won by **East Zone** — their **3rd title**.
- **Para Archery Championship** gold medal won by **Sheetal Devi**.

13. Appointments & Miscellaneous One-Liners

- **Major Nawaniya Shekhawat** appointed as the new **ADC (Aide-de-Camp)** to President **Droupadi Murmu**, replacing **Major Rishabh**, who announced his retirement.
- Chinese President **Xi Jinping** attending the **18th BRICS Summit**.
- **Exercise Yudh Abhyas** — between **India and USA**.
- Home Affairs Ministry may add a new chapter/Article **371** for **Ladakh**.
- Maharashtra Govt's **Raj Kapoor Award** given to **Rani Mukerji**.
- Odisha district where '**Oran Ghotos**' (sacred groves) were recently found: **Balasore**.
- Reappointed for a 2nd term at the **Asia-Pacific Coastal Union**: **Vinay Prakash Singh**.
- **Dedicated Freight Corridor (Western)** — approx. **1,500+ km**, now operational.
- '**Honohon**' — official mascot for the **Asian Games**; India has hosted the Asian Games twice before: **1951** and **1982**.

— Class continues at 11:00 AM with 'Most Repeated GK/GS Questions' (dedicated to SSC CGL & CHSL) —

Daily Current Affairs — Morning Session — MCQ Compilation

All Multiple-Choice Questions Covered in Class | Date: 12 September 2026

Q1. Which operation was launched by NSG Commandos for the security of leaders attending the 18th BRICS Summit in India? <i>Ans: Operation BRICS Kavach</i>	Q2. Which country currently holds the BRICS Chairmanship for 2026? <i>Ans: India</i>
Q3. What is the theme of the 2026 BRICS Summit? <i>Ans: 'Building Resilience and Cooperation for Sustainability'</i>	Q4. What is the total number of full-time member countries of BRICS, and which is the newest member? <i>Ans: 11 members; newest member — Indonesia</i>
Q5. Which Chinese leader is attending the 18th BRICS Summit? <i>Ans: Xi Jinping</i>	Q6. Which Russian leader attended the BRICS Summit in India? <i>Ans: Vladimir Putin</i>
Q7. Which organisation launched the 'UPI Tap & Pay' and 'My UPI Pay' services? <i>Ans: NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India)</i>	Q8. Which place is NOT a site where the Kumbh Mela is organised (from given options)? <i>Ans: Based on options — actual Kumbh Mela sites are Nasik, Ujjain, Haridwar, Prayagraj</i>
Q9. 'Reti' is an opening strategy associated with which sport? <i>Ans: Chess</i>	Q10. Who won the Norway Chess Championship recently? <i>Ans: R. Praggnanandhaa</i>
Q11. What are the constitutional Articles for Rajya Sabha, Lok Sabha, Parliament and the President respectively? <i>Ans: Rajya Sabha – Art. 80; Lok Sabha – Art. 81; Parliament – Art. 79; President – Art. 52</i>	Q12. Who became the first woman Army Officer from Kargil? <i>Ans: Stanzin Sangyan</i>
Q13. What is the highest peak of the Karakoram Range? <i>Ans: K2 (Godwin Austen)</i>	Q14. What is the highest peak of the Ladakh Range? <i>Ans: Rakaposhi / Saltoro Kangri</i>
Q15. What is the highest peak of the Zaskar Range? <i>Ans: Kamet</i>	Q16. What is the highest peak of the Great Himalayan Range? <i>Ans: Mount Everest</i>
Q17. Which body/organisation releases the e-Governance Development Index? <i>Ans: e-Governance/Governance Development Institute/Authority (NOT NITI Aayog)</i>	Q18. Who was the first Deputy Chairperson of the Planning Commission? <i>Ans: Gulzarilal Nanda</i>
Q19. The concept of 'Jobless Growth' is associated with which economic event/period? <i>Ans: The 1991 Economic Reforms (LPG)</i>	Q20. In Mohiniyattam, what does the white saree with a golden border (Kasavu saree) symbolise? <i>Ans: Peace and sacrifice</i>
Q21. What is the name of the saree worn in Mohiniyattam? <i>Ans: Kasavu saree</i>	Q22. 'Exercise Samudra Laxman 2026' is a naval exercise between India and which country? <i>Ans: Malaysia</i>
Q23. What is the capital and currency of Malaysia? <i>Ans: Capital – Kuala Lumpur; Currency – Ringgit</i>	Q24. Name the Army, Navy and Air Force exercises conducted between India and Malaysia. <i>Ans: Army – Harimau Shakti; Navy – Samudra Laxman; Air Force – Udara Shakti</i>
Q25. INS Mysore, which participated in Exercise Samudra Laxman, belongs to which project and class? <i>Ans: Project 15, Delhi-class; built at Mazagon Dock, Mumbai</i>	Q26. 'Exercise Yudh Abhyas' is conducted between India and which country? <i>Ans: USA</i>
Q27. Deficiency of which vitamin causes night blindness (defective night vision)? <i>Ans: Vitamin A (Retinol)</i>	Q28. What was the mascot of the National Games 2022, held in Gujarat? <i>Ans: 'Sawaj' (lion)</i>
Q29. What is the name of the world's first artificial energy island being built by Belgium in the North Sea? <i>Ans: Princess Elizabeth Island</i>	Q30. What is the capital of Belgium, and which two organisations are headquartered there? <i>Ans: Brussels; NATO and the European Union</i>
Q31. Name the strait located between England and France. <i>Ans: Strait of Dover</i>	Q32. Gir Wildlife Sanctuary in Gujarat is famous for which animal? <i>Ans: Asiatic Lion</i>
Q33. Which grassland is associated with the Gir region of Gujarat? <i>Ans: Banni grassland</i>	Q34. Where is the Aravalli Range located, and what is its highest peak? <i>Ans: Rajasthan; highest peak – Guru Shikhar (on Mount Abu)</i>
Q35. What is the new name given to Mount Abu? <i>Ans: 'Abu Raj'</i>	Q36. The Indus Valley Civilisation had trade relations with which two ancient civilisations? <i>Ans: Egypt and Mesopotamia</i>
Q37. The concept of 'Residuary Powers' in the Indian Constitution has been borrowed from which country? <i>Ans: Australia</i>	Q38. What is the full budget allocated under PM-SETU Yojana for developing 3 new ITIs? <i>Ans: Rs. 735.70 crore</i>
Q39. In which three states/locations will the new ITIs under PM-SETU Yojana be developed? <i>Ans: Telangana, Rajasthan, and Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)</i>	Q40. How many ITIs and National Skill Training Institutes are targeted under PM-SETU Yojana? <i>Ans: 200 ITIs and 5 National Skill Training Institutes</i>
Q41. What is the name of the free online coaching scheme launched by Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami? <i>Ans: 'Yuva Bhavishya Nirman Yojana'</i>	Q42. On which date was the Uttarakhand 'Yuva Bhavishya Nirman Yojana' launched, and which day is observed on this date? <i>Ans: 5 September 2026; Teachers' Day (also International Charity Day)</i>
Q43. What is the name of the Karnataka scheme that takes school students on a village exposure tour? <i>Ans: 'Gram Anubhav' Yojana</i>	Q44. Which country's Prime Minister has the highest annual salary in the world? <i>Ans: Singapore (Lawrence Wong)</i>
Q45. Singapore consistently ranks No. 1 on which global passport ranking index? <i>Ans: Henley Passport Index</i>	Q46. How many districts in Bihar are currently affected by floods? <i>Ans: Approximately 15 districts</i>
Q47. Name the three main rivers responsible for the current Bihar floods. <i>Ans: Gandak, Kosi, and Punpun</i>	Q48. The Gandak river is known by which name in Nepal? <i>Ans: Narayani</i>
Q49. Which river is known as the 'Sorrow of Bihar'? <i>Ans: Kosi River</i>	Q50. Which national park is located near the Gandak river in Bihar? <i>Ans: Valmiki National Park</i>

Q51. Who became the fastest Indian (men & women combined) to take 50 wickets in T20 cricket?

Ans: Sree Charani (in 29 matches)

Q53. Who won the Para Archery Championship gold medal recently?

Ans: Sheetal Devi

Q55. Who has been appointed as the new ADC to President Droupadi Murmu?

Ans: Major Nawaniya Shekhawat

Q57. Who received the Raj Kapoor Award from the Maharashtra Government?

Ans: Rani Mukerji

Q59. Who was reappointed for a second term at the Asia-Pacific Coastal Union?

Ans: Vinay Prakash Singh

Q61. How many times has India hosted the Asian Games before, and in which years?

Ans: Twice — 1951 and 1982

Q52. In how many matches did Kuldeep Yadav achieve 50 T20 wickets (for comparison)?

Ans: 30 matches

Q54. Which zone won the recent Dileep Trophy, and which title number is it for them?

Ans: East Zone; their 3rd title

Q56. Which Article of the Constitution may be extended to Ladakh by the Home Affairs Ministry?

Ans: Article 371

Q58. In which Odisha district were 'Oran Ghotos' (sacred groves) recently found?

Ans: Balasore

Q60. 'Honohon' has been released as the official mascot for which multi-sport event?

Ans: Asian Games